Adding a Host to Monitor

In this tutorial, I will add an Ubuntu host to monitor to the Nagios server we have made above.

Nagios Server IP : 192.168.1.9

Ubuntu Host IP : 192.168.1.10

Step 1 - Connect to ubuntu host

ssh root@192.168.1.10

Step 2 - Install NRPE Service

sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y

sudo apt-get install nagios-nrpe-server nagios-plugins -y

Step 3 - Configure NRPE

After the installation is complete, edit the nrpe file /etc/nagios/nrpe.cfg:

vi /etc/nagios/nrpe.cfg

... and add Nagios Server IP 192.168.1.9 to the server_address. (private IP)

server_address=192.168.1.9

Configure server address

Step 4 - Restart NRPE

service nagios-nrpe-server restart

Step 5 - Add Ubuntu Host to Nagios Server

Please connect to the Nagios server:

ssh root@192.168.1.9

After the installation phase is complete, you can find the default configuration of Nagios in /usr/local/nagios/.

We will configure Nagios and Nagios contact.

Edit default nagios configuration with vim:

vi /usr/local/nagios/etc/nagios.cfg

uncomment line 51 for the host monitor configuration.

cfg_dir=/usr/local/nagios/etc/servers

Save and exit.

Add a new folder named servers:

mkdir -p /usr/local/nagios/etc/servers

The Nagios contact can be configured in the contact.cfg file. To open it use:

vi /usr/local/nagios/etc/objects/contacts.cfg

Then replace the default email with your own email.

Set email address.

Then create a new file for the host configuration in /usr/local/nagios/etc/servers/.

to configure multiple host servers create file with different names with extension .cfg and use file name as host name in script given below

vi /usr/local/nagios/etc/servers/ubuntu_host1.cfg

Add the following lines:

```
# Ubuntu Host configuration file
define host {
        use                     linux-server
        host_name               ubuntu_host
        alias                   Ubuntu Host
        address                 192.168.1.10
        register                1
}
define service {
    host_name                   ubuntu_host
    service_description         PING
    check_command               check_ping!100.0,20%!500.0,60%
    max_check_attempts          2
    check_interval              2
    retry_interval              2
    check_period                24x7
    check_freshness             1
    contact_groups              admins
    notification_interval       2
    notification_period         24x7
    notifications_enabled       1
    register                    1
}
```

```
define service {
    host_name                   ubuntu_host
    service_description         Check Users
    check_command         check_local_users!20!50
    max_check_attempts          2
    check_interval              2
    retry_interval              2
    check_period                24x7
    check_freshness             1
    contact_groups              admins
    notification_interval       2
    notification_period         24x7
    notifications_enabled       1
    register                    1
}
define service {
    host_name                   ubuntu_host
    service_description         Local Disk
    check_command               check_local_disk!20%!10%!/
    max_check_attempts          2
    check_interval              2
    retry_interval              2
    check_period                24x7
    check_freshness             1
```

```
    contact_groups              admins
    notification_interval       2
    notification_period         24x7
    notifications_enabled       1
    register                    1
}
define service {
    host_name                   ubuntu_host
    service_description         Check SSH
    check_command               check_ssh
    max_check_attempts          2
    check_interval              2
    retry_interval              2
    check_period                24x7
    check_freshness             1
    contact_groups              admins
    notification_interval       2
    notification_period         24x7
    notifications_enabled       1
    register                    1
}
define service {
    host_name                   ubuntu_host
    service_description         Total Process
```

```
    check_command               check_local_procs!250!400!RSZDT
    max_check_attempts          2
    check_interval              2
    retry_interval              2
    check_period                24x7
    check_freshness             1
    contact_groups              admins
    notification_interval       2
    notification_period         24x7
    notifications_enabled       1
    register                    1
}
```

You can find many check_command in /usr/local/nagios/etc/objects/commands.cfg file. See there if you want to add more services like DHCP, POP etc.

And now check the configuration:

/usr/local/nagios/bin/nagios -v /usr/local/nagios/etc/nagios.cfg

... to see if the configuration is correct.

Step 6 - Restart all services

On the Ubuntu Host start NRPE Service:

service nagios-nrpe-server restart

... and on the Nagios server, start Apache and Nagios:

service apache2 restart

service nagios restart

Step 7 - Testing the Ubuntu Host

Open the Nagios server from the browser and see the ubuntu_host being monitored.

The Ubuntu host is available on monitored host.

All services monitored without error.

All services are green

Conclusion

Nagios is an open source application for monitoring a system. Nagios has been widely used because of the ease of configuration. Nagios in support by various plugins, and you can even create your own plugins.